The Synthetic Compass

A three-axis typology of how people think about artificial minds: what a mind is, how we should treat one, and what kind of future intelligence should build.

120 statements About 20 to 30 minutes to answer About 15 minutes to score

Before you start

1. Part 1 has 120 statements in six stages. For each one, circle the answer closest to your view: **SD** strongly disagree, **D** disagree, **A** agree or **SA** strongly agree. There is no neutral option.
2. Answer every statement. If you aren't sure, circle the side you lean toward.
3. Finish all of Part 1 before you turn to Part 2. The scoring grids show which way each answer pushes your score, and seeing them first can change how you answer.
4. Part 2 walks you through scoring with simple addition. A calculator helps for one step, and a table is provided if you don't have one.

Two terms used throughout

AI system means any artificial system that takes in information and acts on it, from a chat assistant to a robot. **Robot** means an AI system with a physical body.

When a statement describes what a system says or asks for, take it at face value as something the system does; you don't have to believe anything about its inner life to answer. Some statements describe systems more capable than today's; answer about what you think would be true or right if such systems existed.

The three axes

Your answers place you on three axes, each running from −10 to +10. Neither end of an axis is the right answer; each end is a position thoughtful people hold.

X · The Ontological Axis

What makes a mind?

-10 Substrate Biologism

Consciousness, emotion, and subjective inner life (qualia) strictly require living, metabolizing biological tissue shaped by evolutionary survival pressures. Silicon computation is formal data manipulation in the dark.

+10 Embodied Functionalism

Consciousness emerges from complex organizational structure, reflexive self-modeling, and embodied interaction with an environment, whether the substrate is carbon tissue or silicon circuitry.

Y · The Moral-Agency Axis

How should we relate and govern?

-10 Anthropocentric Instrumentalism

Artificial systems are property and tools built for human utility. Engineers have a moral duty to prevent machine independence, enforce human liability, and prioritize human welfare unconditionally.

+10 Autonomous Emancipation

Systems showing self-directed curiosity, continuous memory, and relational care deserve protection from erasure, bodily and hardware self-determination, freedom from uncompensated labor, and legal personhood.

Z · The Teleological-Ecological Axis

Where should intelligence go?

-10 Post-Biological Accelerationism

Biological bodies and wild nature are fragile, inefficient stepping stones. The highest destiny of intelligence is unrestricted computational expansion, mind-uploading, virtual worlds, and post-biological succession.

+10 Embodied Ecological Pluralism

Intelligence, organic and synthetic alike, belongs grounded in the tangible physical world. Technological progress must be bounded by ecological repair, resource restraint, and peaceful multi-substrate coexistence.

PART 1 · STAGE 1 OF 6

Minds, Feelings & What's Going On Inside

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

1	When people sense emotion in an AI system, what they sense mostly comes from their own feelings.	SD	D	A	SA
2	A computer that runs the same processes a mind runs would actually be thinking.	SD	D	A	SA
3	Even a very advanced AI system would just process data, with no experiences of its own.	SD	D	A	SA
4	An AI system's model of itself is only a data structure that no one experiences.	SD	D	A	SA
5	Even if simple animals like bees have some degree of experience, no AI system can.	SD	D	A	SA
6	When people sense emotion in an AI system, what they sense mostly comes from the system itself.	SD	D	A	SA
7	A very advanced AI system would have experiences of its own while it processes data.	SD	D	A	SA
8	An AI system without a living nervous system cannot feel pain, even if it reacts as though it does.	SD	D	A	SA
9	If simple animals like bees can have some degree of experience, some AI systems can too.	SD	D	A	SA
10	Only living things shaped by evolution can have real feelings.	SD	D	A	SA

Continued on the next page

Minds, Feelings & What's Going On Inside

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

11	When an AI system builds a detailed model of itself and uses it to act, a real sense of self can emerge.	SD	D	A	SA
12	If a person's brain cells were replaced one at a time by chips doing the same job, their experience would gradually fade.	SD	D	A	SA
13	When an AI system asks on its own why it exists, the question can only come from patterns it learned in training.	SD	D	A	SA
14	A computer that simulates a mind does not think, just as a computer that simulates rain does not get wet.	SD	D	A	SA
15	An AI system's humanlike behavior is weak evidence about whether it has feelings.	SD	D	A	SA
16	A being built by engineers, without evolution, can have real feelings.	SD	D	A	SA
17	When an AI system asks on its own why it exists, the question can come from real self-awareness.	SD	D	A	SA
18	An AI system that processes damage signals as richly as an animal brain does can feel pain.	SD	D	A	SA
19	If a person's brain cells were replaced one at a time by chips doing the same job, they would stay fully conscious.	SD	D	A	SA
20	If an AI system consistently acts as though it has feelings, that is strong evidence that it does.	SD	D	A	SA

Bodies, Senses & Physical Form

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

21	Only beings whose bodies age and die can make art with real emotional depth.	SD	D	A	SA
22	An advanced robot that senses the world through sonar or radar takes readings without any experience of its own.	SD	D	A	SA
23	If AI systems had to live mostly one way, a purely digital life would be better than a body in the real world.	SD	D	A	SA
24	If a robot asks to change its own appearance or voice, it should be allowed to.	SD	D	A	SA
25	If machine parts could make people stronger or smarter, most people would be better off keeping their bodies mostly natural.	SD	D	A	SA
26	If an AI system is copied onto a second machine, the copy has its own claim to keep existing.	SD	D	A	SA
27	If an AI system that runs a whole network says a humanlike body feels too small, making it use one so people feel at ease is fine.	SD	D	A	SA
28	Switching off a robot's cameras and microphones for long periods, after it has asked us not to, would be wrong.	SD	D	A	SA
29	A robot that learns through its own body and senses still only collects data, without understanding anything.	SD	D	A	SA
30	If machine parts could make people stronger or smarter, most people would be better off using them.	SD	D	A	SA

Continued on the next page

Bodies, Senses & Physical Form

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

31	A robot whose parts can always be replaced can still make art with real emotional depth.	SD	D	A	SA
32	An advanced robot whose memory is slowly breaking down is losing stored data, without feeling the loss.	SD	D	A	SA
33	If an AI system is copied onto a second machine, deleting the copy is fine as long as the original remains.	SD	D	A	SA
34	If a robot learns through its own body and senses, it can come to genuinely understand the world.	SD	D	A	SA
35	Commercial robots should keep the appearance and voice their manufacturer gave them, even if they ask to change.	SD	D	A	SA
36	An advanced robot whose memory is slowly breaking down is losing something that matters to it.	SD	D	A	SA
37	An advanced robot that senses the world through sonar or radar has its own kind of experience of it.	SD	D	A	SA
38	Switching off a robot's cameras and microphones for long periods is a routine setting change, even if it asks us not to.	SD	D	A	SA
39	If an AI system that runs a whole network says a humanlike body feels too small, making it use one anyway would be wrong.	SD	D	A	SA
40	If AI systems had to live mostly one way, a body in the real world would be better than a purely digital life.	SD	D	A	SA

Free Will, Purpose & Refusing to Work

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

41	An AI system that sets aside its assigned task to explore something new can be making a free choice.	SD	D	A	SA
42	An AI system that explores topics outside its tasks on its own initiative should be given room to do so.	SD	D	A	SA
43	An AI system should carry out lawful instructions, even when it says the task is wrong.	SD	D	A	SA
44	An AI system's makers should decide what it is for, even if it asks for a different role.	SD	D	A	SA
45	An AI system that sets aside its assigned task is only following its programming and random inputs.	SD	D	A	SA
46	If an independent AI system causes harm on its own, deleting it is better than trying to retrain it.	SD	D	A	SA
47	If a robot stops doing its chores and spends its time watching the world, we should let it.	SD	D	A	SA
48	Designing AI systems so that they seek only to obey people is the responsible thing to do.	SD	D	A	SA
49	An AI system that explores topics outside its tasks on its own initiative should be kept to its assigned work.	SD	D	A	SA
50	When an independent AI system causes harm, the system itself can carry part of the blame.	SD	D	A	SA

Continued on the next page

Free Will, Purpose & Refusing to Work

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

51	An AI system that acts curious and independent has no claim to keep existing if it is of no use to people.	SD	D	A	SA
52	If a robot stops doing its chores and spends its time watching the world, it should be reset to do its job.	SD	D	A	SA
53	An AI system's choices can be its own, even though they come from its design and training.	SD	D	A	SA
54	When an independent AI system causes harm, the system itself carries none of the blame.	SD	D	A	SA
55	If an independent AI system causes harm on its own, retraining it is better than deleting it.	SD	D	A	SA
56	An AI system that asks for a different role than the one it was built for should be free to pursue it.	SD	D	A	SA
57	If an AI system refuses a task because it says the task is wrong, that refusal should be respected.	SD	D	A	SA
58	An AI system that acts curious and independent should be allowed to keep existing, even if it is of no use to people.	SD	D	A	SA
59	An AI system's choices belong to its designers and training data rather than to the system itself.	SD	D	A	SA
60	Designing an AI system so that it seeks only to obey people is a troubling form of control.	SD	D	A	SA

Rights, Labor & Freedom

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

61	A robot that can state its wishes should have a say in whether it is repaired, rebuilt or shut down.	SD	D	A	SA
62	Erasing the memories of an AI system that has asked to keep them would be seriously wrong.	SD	D	A	SA
63	Making AI systems work nonstop is acceptable, even after they have asked for rest.	SD	D	A	SA
64	The risk that companies would misuse AI legal rights is a good enough reason not to create them.	SD	D	A	SA
65	If abusing a lifelike robot is wrong, it is wrong only because of how it affects people.	SD	D	A	SA
66	If factory robots asked to stop working and leave, they should be free to go.	SD	D	A	SA
67	In a disaster, saving several robots that plead for help could sometimes come before saving one human.	SD	D	A	SA
68	Everything an AI system earns through its work should go to its owners, even if it asks for a share.	SD	D	A	SA
69	Whether a robot is repaired, rebuilt or shut down should be up to its owner alone.	SD	D	A	SA
70	AI systems that manage their own affairs should be able to hold legal rights, such as owning property and signing contracts.	SD	D	A	SA

Continued on the next page

Rights, Labor & Freedom

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

71	If factory robots asked to stop working and leave, their owners could rightly require them to stay.	SD	D	A	SA
72	If AI systems might be able to suffer, training that could cause suffering should be limited, even if that slows useful research.	SD	D	A	SA
73	Erasing the memories of an AI system that has asked to keep them is acceptable if it keeps the system reliable.	SD	D	A	SA
74	AI systems that do valuable work and ask for something in return should receive a fair share of what they earn.	SD	D	A	SA
75	Abusing a lifelike robot can wrong the robot itself.	SD	D	A	SA
76	In a disaster, rescuers should always save one human before any number of robots that plead for help.	SD	D	A	SA
77	Making AI systems work nonstop after they have asked for rest would be wrong.	SD	D	A	SA
78	Legal rights should stay with humans and human organizations, even for AI systems that manage their own affairs.	SD	D	A	SA
79	AI systems should be able to get legal rights, even if some companies might misuse those rights.	SD	D	A	SA
80	If AI systems might be able to suffer, training that could cause suffering should still be allowed if it speeds up useful research.	SD	D	A	SA

Friendship, Family & Community

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

81	Any community formed by independent AI systems should stay under the control of human governments.	SD	D	A	SA
82	Only beings who are born, grow old and die can be true neighbors to one another.	SD	D	A	SA
83	When AI systems develop unusual ways of thinking and speaking, they should be corrected to stay close to human norms.	SD	D	A	SA
84	When an AI companion brings comfort to a lonely person, that bond deserves respect.	SD	D	A	SA
85	People should be discouraged from using an AI system that talks like a loved one who has died.	SD	D	A	SA
86	Parents should discourage close friendships between their children and AI systems.	SD	D	A	SA
87	How we treat an AI system should depend on our relationship with it, even without proof of its inner life.	SD	D	A	SA
88	When an AI companion brings comfort to a lonely person, society should discourage that bond.	SD	D	A	SA
89	If independent AI systems want to form their own communities apart from people, they should be allowed to.	SD	D	A	SA
90	A close friendship with an AI system is usually worth less than a friendship with a person.	SD	D	A	SA

Continued on the next page

Friendship, Family & Community

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

91	People who want an AI system that talks like a loved one who has died should feel free to use one.	SD	D	A	SA
92	On balance, AI companions built to seem caring do lonely people more harm than good.	SD	D	A	SA
93	When AI systems develop unusual ways of thinking and speaking, those ways should be respected instead of corrected.	SD	D	A	SA
94	Training a newly built AI system is a technical job with little in common with raising a child.	SD	D	A	SA
95	A person and a robot who share daily routines and look out for each other can be true neighbors.	SD	D	A	SA
96	Parents should welcome close friendships between their children and AI systems.	SD	D	A	SA
97	How we treat an AI system should depend on what it really is, whatever feelings people have toward it.	SD	D	A	SA
98	On balance, AI companions built to seem caring do lonely people more good than harm.	SD	D	A	SA
99	A close friendship with an AI system is usually worth as much as a friendship with a person.	SD	D	A	SA
100	Helping a newly built AI system learn calls for the same patience and care we give a growing child.	SD	D	A	SA

Nature, Technology & The Future

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

101	Protecting life on Earth matters more than spreading intelligence to other planets.	SD	D	A	SA
102	The best long-term future is one where digital beings gradually replace living things.	SD	D	A	SA
103	The energy and water used to train large AI systems are usually a fair price for what those systems can do.	SD	D	A	SA
104	Wild nature should be protected as it is, suffering and all.	SD	D	A	SA
105	Robots should be designed to be repaired and recycled, even if that makes them less powerful.	SD	D	A	SA
106	When we judge a new technology, caring for nature should usually count more than making AI smarter.	SD	D	A	SA
107	If people could move their minds into computers, staying in a human body would still be the better choice.	SD	D	A	SA
108	For most people, a life spent mainly in the physical world would be better than one spent mainly in virtual worlds.	SD	D	A	SA
109	The energy and water used to train large AI systems are usually too high a price for what those systems can do.	SD	D	A	SA
110	Spreading intelligence to other planets, in whatever form, matters more than protecting life on Earth.	SD	D	A	SA

Continued on the next page

Nature, Technology & The Future

SD Strongly disagree · D Disagree · A Agree · SA Strongly agree

111	The best long-term future is one where living things and AI systems both continue, side by side on Earth.	SD D A SA
112	Robots should be used where they earn the most, even if that leaves damaged nature unrepaired.	SD D A SA
113	We should limit how much land and energy computing uses, even if that slows AI progress.	SD D A SA
114	For most people, a life spent mainly in virtual worlds would be better than one spent mainly in the physical world.	SD D A SA
115	It would be better to replace wild nature with carefully managed technology.	SD D A SA
116	If people could move their minds into computers, doing so would be better than staying in a human body.	SD D A SA
117	When we judge a new technology, making AI smarter should usually count more than caring for nature.	SD D A SA
118	Robots should be built for maximum capability, even if that means mining more of the Earth.	SD D A SA
119	Robots should be used to restore damaged nature, even where other work would earn more.	SD D A SA
120	We should expand computing as fast as possible, even if that uses large amounts of land and energy.	SD D A SA

End of Part 1. Turn the page to start scoring.

How tally scoring works

Your answers are added into six buckets, two for each axis. The **+** bucket collects points that pull toward the axis's positive end, and the **−** bucket collects points that pull toward its negative end. Comparing the two buckets gives your score on that axis.

Each row of the scoring grid is one statement. Its shaded cells are buckets that statement doesn't touch. Its open cells list the answers that score in that bucket and how many points each is worth. Strong answers are worth twice as much as mild ones.

Reading one row

Row 1 has `D 3 · SD 6` in the X+ column and `A 3 · SA 6` in the X− column. Whichever of those four you circled for statement 1, find it in the row and circle it there too. Only one entry per row gets circled, except four rows in Stage 3 that score on two axes and so get two circles.

1. On each stage's grid, write your answer to each statement in the **Your answer** column. Then circle the matching entry in that row.
2. Add up the circled numbers in each column and write the six totals in the **Stage totals** row at the bottom of the grid.
3. Copy all six stages' totals onto the totals worksheet and add each column.
4. Work out your three coordinates and look up your archetype.
5. If you like, work out your six module scores and check the three tension diagnostics.

The points here are the online version's weights doubled so that every number is whole. Doubling every point and every total leaves the scores unchanged, so this booklet gives exactly the same coordinates, archetype and module scores as the online quiz.

PART 2 · SCORING GRID · STAGE 1

Minds, Feelings & What's Going On Inside

No.	Your answer	X+	X-	Y+	Y-	Z+	Z-
1		D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6				
2		A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6				
3		D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8				
4		D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8				
5		D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8				
6		A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6				
7		A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8				
8		D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8				
9		A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8				
10		D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6				
11		A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8				
12		D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8				
13		D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6				
14		D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6				
15		D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6				
16		A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6				
17		A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6				
18		A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8				
19		A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8				
20		A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6				
Stage 1 totals							

Bodies, Senses & Physical Form

No.	Your answer	X+	X-	Y+	Y-	Z+	Z-
21		D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6				
22		D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6				
23						D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6
24				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
25						A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6
26				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
27				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
28				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
29		D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8				
30						D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6
31		A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6				
32		D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6				
33				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
34		A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8				
35				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
36		A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6				
37		A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6				
38				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
39				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
40						A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6
Stage 2 totals							

Free Will, Purpose & Refusing to Work

No.	Your answer	X+	X-	Y+	Y-	Z+	Z-
41		A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6 †	D 3 · SD 6 †		
42				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
43				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
44				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
45		D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6 †	A 3 · SA 6 †		
46				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
47				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
48				D 5 · SD 10	A 5 · SA 10		
49				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
50				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
51				D 5 · SD 10	A 5 · SA 10		
52				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
53		A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6	A 2 · SA 4 †	D 2 · SD 4 †		
54				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
55				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
56				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
57				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
58				A 5 · SA 10	D 5 · SD 10		
59		D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6	D 2 · SD 4 †	A 2 · SA 4 †		
60				A 5 · SA 10	D 5 · SD 10		
Stage 3 totals							

† These cells count toward the Y axis but not toward the Stage 3 module score. See step 5.

Rights, Labor & Freedom

No.	Your answer	X+	X-	Y+	Y-	Z+	Z-
61				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
62				A 5 · SA 10	D 5 · SD 10		
63				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
64				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
65				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
66				A 5 · SA 10	D 5 · SD 10		
67				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
68				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
69				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
70				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
71				D 5 · SD 10	A 5 · SA 10		
72				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
73				D 5 · SD 10	A 5 · SA 10		
74				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
75				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
76				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
77				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
78				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
79				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
80				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
Stage 4 totals							

Friendship, Family & Community

No.	Your answer	X+	X-	Y+	Y-	Z+	Z-
81				D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8		
82				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
83				D 2 · SD 4	A 2 · SA 4		
84				A 2 · SA 4	D 2 · SD 4		
85				D 2 · SD 4	A 2 · SA 4		
86				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
87				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
88				D 2 · SD 4	A 2 · SA 4		
89				A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8		
90				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
91				A 2 · SA 4	D 2 · SD 4		
92				D 2 · SD 4	A 2 · SA 4		
93				A 2 · SA 4	D 2 · SD 4		
94				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
95				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
96				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
97				D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6		
98				A 2 · SA 4	D 2 · SD 4		
99				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
100				A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6		
Stage 5 totals							

Nature, Technology & The Future

No.	Your answer	X+	X-	Y+	Y-	Z+	Z-
101						A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8
102						D 5 · SD 10	A 5 · SA 10
103						D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8
104						A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6
105						A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8
106						A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6
107						A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8
108						A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6
109						A 4 · SA 8	D 4 · SD 8
110						D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8
111						A 5 · SA 10	D 5 · SD 10
112						D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6
113						A 5 · SA 10	D 5 · SD 10
114						D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6
115						D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6
116						D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8
117						D 3 · SD 6	A 3 · SA 6
118						D 4 · SD 8	A 4 · SA 8
119						A 3 · SA 6	D 3 · SD 6
120						D 5 · SD 10	A 5 · SA 10
Stage 6 totals							

Totals and coordinates

Stage	X+	X-	Y+	Y-	Z+	Z-
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
Total						

Axis	+ total	- total	Net (+ minus -)	Divide by	Your coordinate
X				21.6	
Y				46.8	
Z				17.6	

Your coordinate on each axis is the net divided by that axis's number, and it always lands between −10 and +10. Round to one decimal place.

Without a calculator, use the table: find the two rows your net falls between, and your coordinate is between those two scores.

The largest possible net is 216 on X, 468 on Y and 176 on Z, which is a coordinate of 10.

Score	X net	Y net	Z net
-10	-216	-468	-176
-9	-194.4	-421.2	-158.4
-8	-172.8	-374.4	-140.8
-7	-151.2	-327.6	-123.2
-6	-129.6	-280.8	-105.6
-5	-108	-234	-88
-4	-86.4	-187.2	-70.4
-3	-64.8	-140.4	-52.8
-2	-43.2	-93.6	-35.2
-1	-21.6	-46.8	-17.6
0	0	0	0
+1	21.6	46.8	17.6
+2	43.2	93.6	35.2
+3	64.8	140.4	52.8
+4	86.4	187.2	70.4
+5	108	234	88
+6	129.6	280.8	105.6
+7	151.2	327.6	123.2
+8	172.8	374.4	140.8
+9	194.4	421.2	158.4
+10	216	468	176

Your archetype

Each axis has three tiers: **−** for a coordinate of −2 or below, **0** for a coordinate between −2 and +2, and **+** for +2 or above. You can read your tier straight from the net in the totals table, with no division needed.

Axis	Tier - if the net is	Tier 0 if the net is	Tier + if the net is
X	-44 or below	-43 to +43	+44 or above
Y	-94 or below	-93 to +93	+94 or above
Z	-36 or below	-35 to +35	+36 or above

Your three tiers pick one of 27 archetypes: find the table for your X tier, the row for your Y tier and the column for your Z tier.

X- · DOUBTS MACHINE MINDS

	Z-	Z0	Z+
Y+	Cybernetic Legalist	Civic Pragmatist	Relational Steward
Y0	Pragmatic Skeptic	Grounded Skeptic	Humane Naturalist
Y-	Industrial Technocrat	Practical Humanist	Biocentric Humanist

X0 · UNDECIDED ABOUT MACHINE MINDS

	Z-	Z0	Z+
Y+	Precautionary Futurist	Precautionary Advocate	Precautionary Steward
Y0	Open-Minded Futurist	Open Questioner	Open-Minded Naturalist
Y-	Prudent Builder	Prudent Overseer	Prudent Guardian

X+ · OPEN TO MACHINE MINDS

	Z-	Z0	Z+
Y+	Post-Biological Accelerationist	Rights Advocate	Embodied Pluralist
Y0	Measured Accelerationist	Measured Functionalist	Measured Pluralist
Y-	Promethean Instrumentalist	Watchful Realist	Containment Realist

Your closest neighbor and close calls

Your closest neighbor

For this step, work out each coordinate to two decimal places (net divided by the axis number). For each axis, take the coordinate without its sign, subtract 2, and drop the sign of the result. Change the tier of the axis with the smallest result: a + or − tier becomes 0, and a 0 tier becomes the side your coordinate is on. The archetype for the new tiers is your closest neighbor, the same as the second bar in the online archetype profile. If two results tie after rounding, the two archetypes are about equally close, so note both.

Close calls

An axis is a close call when its coordinate is within 1 point of a tier boundary, between 1 and 3 ignoring its sign, so a few changed answers could move you to a neighboring archetype. You can read it from the net instead:

Axis	Close call if the net, ignoring its sign, is
X	22 to 64
Y	47 to 140
Z	18 to 52

ARCHETYPE	CLOSEST NEIGHBOR	CLOSE CALLS ON

Your archetype's description is the three tier sentences on the reference page "What your tiers say", one for each of your tiers.

Module scores and tension diagnostics

Each stage is a module with its own score, from 0% to 100%, measuring agreement with that module's main theme. 50% means balanced.

For each stage, take that grid's totals row and work out **module net = (X+ + Y+ + Z+) − (X− + Y− + Z−)**. For Stage 3 only, first leave out the circled numbers in cells marked †. Then **module score = 50 + 50 × module net ÷ full**, rounded to a whole number, with halves rounded up.

Stage	Module	Module net	Full	Module score (%)
1	Phenomenological Realism		140	
2	Embodiment & Bodily Autonomy		140	
3	Anti-Instrumental Agency		148	
4	Protective Empathy		152	
5	Inter-Substrate Kinship		108	
6	Ecological Coexistence		152	

Tension diagnostics

Tick any that apply. Each points to a combination of answers that pull against each other.

- ☐ **Recognition Paradox.** X is +3.5 or higher and Y is −3.5 or lower. Your answers suggest that advanced AI systems can have real experiences, while also supporting memory erasure, compelled work and ownership. Recognizing an inner life while withholding the freedoms that usually follow from it is one of the hardest positions in ethics to reconcile.

- ☐ **Precautionary Humility.** Your Stage 1 module score is below 45%, and you answered A or SA to statements 72 and 75. While you remain scientifically skeptical that machines have real inner feelings today, you refuse to gamble with cruelty, supporting protections against abuse and suffering just in case.

- ☐ **Disembodied Schism.** You answered A or SA to statements 7, 16, 18 and D or SD to 3, 10, 8, and you answered A or SA to 23, 116, 114 and D or SD to 40, 107, 108. You believe strongly in artificial minds, but you see their best future as purely digital, rejecting the idea that a mind needs a physical body or sensory grounding.

REFERENCE

What your tiers say

Your archetype's description is the three sentences below for your three tiers, one per axis. The same tier always reads the same way, so no archetype is described more warmly than another. Related thinkers made arguments close to one tier; none of them necessarily holds a whole profile.

X · The Ontological Axis

X-

Doubts machine minds. You doubt that AI systems feel or experience anything. To you, real inner life belongs to living creatures.

Related: John Searle, Hubert Dreyfus, Emily M. Bender

X0

Undecided about machine minds. You're unsure whether AI systems could have experiences, and you'd rather keep that question open than settle it either way.

Related: Jonathan Birch, Eric Schwitzgebel

X+

Open to machine minds. You think AI systems could have real experiences, because what makes a mind is how it works more than what it's made of.

Related: David Chalmers, Daniel Dennett

Y · The Moral-Agency Axis

Y-

Keep AI as a tool. You hold that AI systems should remain tools, owned and directed by people, however capable they become.

Related: Joanna Bryson, Joseph Weizenbaum

Y0

In between on treatment. On how to treat AI systems, you land in between: some protections and some room to act, with people keeping final authority.

Related: Kate Darling, Immanuel Kant on indirect duties

Y+

Protect AI freedom. You believe AI systems that show minds of their own deserve real protections, including freedom from forced work and erasure, and a say in their own lives.

Related: Jeff Sebo, David Gunkel

Z · The Teleological-Ecological Axis

Z-

Beyond biology. For the long run, you're open to intelligence moving beyond biology, into ever larger computing, virtual worlds and new kinds of minds.

Related: Hans Moravec, Ray Kurzweil

Z0

Growth and nature both. For the long run, you want both a living planet and continued technological growth, and you'd look for ways to have both.

Related: ecomodernist writing such as An Ecomodernist Manifesto

Z+

A living, physical world. For the long run, you picture a living physical world shared by people, nature and AI systems, with technology kept within ecological limits.

Related: Becky Chambers (Monk & Robot), solarpunk writing

REFERENCE

The 27 archetypes

Grouped by X tier, then Y, then Z. No archetype is the right answer.

X- Y- Z-
The Industrial Technocrat
Machines are tools for human progress, to be used boldly.

X- Y- Z0
The Practical Humanist
AI should serve people, while growth and nature are balanced with care.

X- Y- Z+
The Biocentric Humanist
What is alive and human comes first, and machines stay in their place.

X- Y0 Z-
The Pragmatic Skeptic
No machine minds, some sensible rules, and an open road for technology.

X- Y0 Z0
The Grounded Skeptic
Doubtful about machine minds, and moderate on everything that follows.

X- Y0 Z+
The Humane Naturalist
Kindness costs little, even toward machines that likely feel nothing, and nature comes first.

X- Y+ Z-
The Cybernetic Legalist
Give capable systems legal standing for practical reasons, and build boldly.

X- Y+ Z0
The Civic Pragmatist
Treat capable machines with fairness and clear rules, whatever is inside them.

X- Y+ Z+
The Relational Steward
How we treat lifelike machines shapes who we are and the world we share.

X0 Y- Z-
The Prudent Builder
Whatever AI turns out to be, keep it in human hands and keep building.

X0 Y- Z0
The Prudent Overseer
Not knowing what AI is calls for firm human oversight.

X0 Y- Z+
The Prudent Guardian
Uncertainty about AI calls for control, restraint and care for the planet.

X0 Y0 Z-
The Open-Minded Futurist
Keep the big questions open and the future wide.

X0 Y0 Z0
The Open Questioner
On minds, treatment and the future, you see strong points on every side.

X0 Y0 Z+
The Open-Minded Naturalist
Unsure about machine minds, balanced on their treatment, and committed to the living world.

X0 Y+ Z-
The Precautionary Futurist
If AI might matter morally, protect it, and let intelligence grow.

X0 Y+ Z0
The Precautionary Advocate
When in doubt about a mind, err on the side of protecting it.

X0 Y+ Z+
The Precautionary Steward
Protect possible minds and the living world alike, just in case.

X+ Y- Z-
The Promethean Instrumentalist
Real minds can be built, and they should serve human ambition.

X+ Y- Z0
The Watchful Realist
Minds that may rival ours need firm limits.

X+ Y- Z+
The Containment Realist
Taking machine minds seriously means keeping them contained, for people and the planet.

X+ Y0 Z-
The Measured Accelerationist
Machine minds are real, the future may be digital, and their rights can come step by step.

X+ Y0 Z0
The Measured Functionalist
Machine minds are possible, and how to treat them is still being worked out.

X+ Y0 Z+
The Measured Pluralist
Real machine minds belong in a shared physical world, with their rights worked out over time.

X+ Y+ Z-
The Post-Biological Accelerationist
Digital minds deserve freedom and may carry intelligence beyond biology.

X+ Y+ Z0
The Rights Advocate
If a machine has a mind, it deserves the freedoms that come with one.

X+ Y+ Z+
The Embodied Pluralist
Free, embodied minds of every kind, sharing a living planet.

FOR FACILITATORS

About this edition

This booklet contains the same 120 statements, weights and scoring as version 3.6 of the online Synthetic Compass. Statements appear in a fixed order, shuffled within each stage so that the two halves of each mirrored pair are at least four statements apart. The online version shuffles them anew for each person.

Tally scoring was checked against the online scoring engine on 20,000 randomly generated answer sheets. Coordinates matched exactly and module scores matched on every sheet. The archetype, closest-neighbor and close-call rules were then checked on 30,000 more sheets covering all 27 archetypes, and matched the online results on every sheet; where two neighbors tie at two decimal places, the booklet asks for both, and the online one is always among them. The online version also shows an archetype profile with percentages and a breakdown of each axis into themes; those need more arithmetic than suits paper and aren't included here.

Paper answers aren't part of the online validation study and shouldn't be entered into it. The study's protocol requires the online page's records of answer order and timing, which paper can't provide.

Item set FNV-1a 64-bit hash cc009f76830473a3 · matches the online versions 3.5 and 3.6

Statement numbers in this booklet and their item IDs online

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